MAKKAH ZIYARAT: 19

TWO HOLY MOSQUES EXHIBITION

Location

Um al-Joud area, near the Kiswa Factory, approximately 10 kilometres from Masjid al-Haram, Makkah.

Timings

Sunday to Thursday, 8:00 AM to 8:00 PM; closed Friday and Saturday; may close briefly during prayer times.

About This Site

The Two Holy Mosques Exhibition, is a distinguished museum and cultural centre located in the Um al-Joud area of Makkah, near the historic Kiswa Factory. Inaugurated on 1 February 2000 during the reign of King Fahd bin Abdulaziz, this exhibition is dedicated to preserving and presenting the rich architectural, artistic, and spiritual heritage of the two holiest sites in Islam: the Grand Mosque in Makkah (Masjid al-Haram) and the Prophet's Mosque in Madinah (Masjid al-Nabawi).

For pilgrims and visitors, the exhibition offers a unique opportunity to explore centuries of Islamic history through rare artifacts, ancient manuscripts, historical photographs, architectural models, and sacred objects connected with the care and development of the Two Holy Mosques. It stands as a testament to the deep reverence and continuous devotion shown by Muslim rulers, scholars, and craftsmen towards these blessed places.

The site is especially meaningful for those who wish to understand the historical journey of the Haramain, from their earliest foundations to the magnificent structures that stand today. It

Two Holy Mosques Exhibition

connects visitors with the stories of sacrifice, faith, and service that have shaped these sacred spaces over more than fourteen centuries.

Historical Significance

Origins and Purpose of the Exhibition

The Two Holy Mosques Exhibition was established to document and celebrate the architectural evolution and spiritual significance of Masjid al-Haram and Masjid al-Nabawi. Its creation reflects a broader effort by the Kingdom of Saudi Arabia to preserve Islamic heritage and make it accessible to pilgrims, scholars, and visitors from around the world.

The exhibition was inaugurated in 2000 as part of ongoing initiatives to enrich the experience of Hajj and Umrah pilgrims. It serves not only as a museum but also as an educational resource, offering insights into the historical, artistic, and religious dimensions of the Two Holy Mosques.

Architectural Evolution of the Haramain

One of the central themes of the exhibition is the architectural transformation of the Grand Mosque and the Prophet's Mosque across different historical periods. Visitors can explore:

- Models and diagrams showing the expansion and renovation of both mosques over time.
- Historical photographs documenting changes in structure, design, and capacity.
- Information about the materials, techniques, and craftsmanship used in various eras.
- The role of different Islamic caliphates and kingdoms in maintaining and enhancing the sacred spaces.

Two Holy Mosques Exhibition

This journey through architectural history helps visitors appreciate the scale of effort and devotion invested in caring for the places where millions of Muslims pray every day.

Sacred Artifacts and Manuscripts

The exhibition houses a remarkable collection of sacred objects and historical items, including:

- Rare manuscripts and copies of the Noble Qur'an retrieved from the libraries of the Grand Mosque and the Prophet's Mosque.
- Ancient photographs and documents related to the Haramain.
- Six marble tiles engraved with the word "Allah", the name of the Prophet Muhammad ﷺ, and the names of the Four Rightly Guided Caliphs (RA), dating back to 1299 AH.
- Items connected with the Kaaba, including historical elements from its structure and decoration.

These artifacts provide a tangible connection to the spiritual and intellectual heritage of Islam, allowing visitors to reflect on the continuity of faith and knowledge across generations.

The Role of the Kiswa and Sacred Services

Located near the Kiswa Factory, the exhibition also highlights the honoured tradition of producing and maintaining the Kiswa, the sacred cloth that covers the Kaaba. This connection underscores the deep care and reverence with which the Haramain have been served throughout history.

The exhibition sheds light on:

- The history of the Kiswa and its symbolic importance.

Two Holy Mosques Exhibition

- The craftsmanship involved in its creation.
- The broader network of services dedicated to the care of the Two Holy Mosques, including water supply, lighting, cleaning, and security.

Connection with the Wider History of Makkah

The Two Holy Mosques Exhibition is not only about architecture and artifacts. It is also a window into the wider history of Makkah as a centre of faith, scholarship, and pilgrimage. Through its displays, visitors can learn about:

- The significance of Makkah in Islamic tradition.
- The role of the city in the life of our beloved Prophet Muhammad ﷺ and the early Muslim community.
- The contributions of scholars, pilgrims, and rulers to the development of the Haramain.
- The ongoing efforts to preserve and enhance these sacred spaces for future generations.

A Journey Through Time and Devotion

Walking through the Two Holy Mosques Exhibition feels like stepping into a living timeline of Islamic history. Each artifact, photograph, and model tells a story of faith, sacrifice, and service. Visitors can trace the journey of the Haramain from their humble beginnings to their current status as centres of global Islamic worship.

The exhibition invites reflection on:

- The continuity of care for the Two Holy Mosques across centuries.
- The devotion of those who served and continue to serve these sacred places.

Two Holy Mosques Exhibition

- The spiritual connection that binds Muslims worldwide to Makkah and Madinah.
- The importance of preserving Islamic heritage for future generations.

The Site Today

Today, the Two Holy Mosques Exhibition is a well-maintained cultural and educational facility. It features:

- Carefully curated displays of artifacts, manuscripts, and models.
- Informative panels in Arabic and other languages.
- A quiet, respectful atmosphere suitable for reflection and learning.

Visitors should note:

- The exhibition is closed on Friday and Saturday.
- It may close briefly during the five daily prayer times.
- Admission is typically free, and no advance booking is usually required.
- The exact location is near the Kiswa Factory in the Um al-Joud area, easily accessible by car or taxi from central Makkah.

The original historical structures and artifacts displayed are preserved with great care, and visitors can trust that what they see is authentically connected with the history of the Haramain.

Why Pilgrims Still Visit

The Two Holy Mosques Exhibition remains meaningful because it deepens understanding of the sacred places that lie at the heart of Islamic worship. For pilgrims, it offers:

Two Holy Mosques Exhibition

- A chance to learn about the history and development of Masjid al-Haram and Masjid al-Nabawi.
- Inspiration from the stories of devotion and service connected with the Haramain.
- A deeper appreciation of the spiritual and architectural heritage of Islam.
- An opportunity to reflect on the continuity of faith across generations.

While visiting the exhibition is not an act of worship in itself, it enriches the pilgrim's experience by connecting them with the historical and cultural dimensions of the Haramain.

Frequently Asked Questions

Where is the Two Holy Mosques Exhibition located in Makkah?

It is located in the Um al-Joud area, near the Kiswa Factory, approximately 10 kilometres from Masjid al-Haram.

What can visitors see at the Two Holy Mosques Exhibition?

Visitors can see rare artifacts, ancient manuscripts, historical photographs, architectural models, and sacred objects connected with the Grand Mosque and the Prophet's Mosque.

Is the Two Holy Mosques Exhibition open every day?

No, it is open Sunday to Thursday from 8:00 AM to 8:00 PM and is closed on Friday and Saturday; it may also close briefly during prayer times.

Two Holy Mosques Exhibition